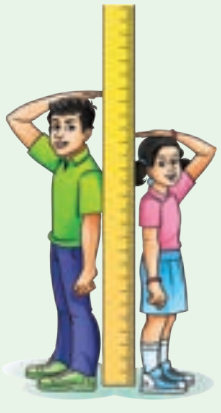


3. Notice, in between 1 and 2 there will be smaller markings. If you count, there will be 9 such lines. The distance between any two consecutive smaller markings within a 'cm' denotes a millimetre (written as 'mm').

Why do we need SI Units?

Activity 1

Form a group of 5 members. Select one person and let others measure her/ his height individually using hand span and cubit. Compare your answers with others. Do you find any difference? Why? Now you all stand in front of a wall and mark your height on the wall. Measure your height with a scale. What differences do you infer?



From the activity 1, you see that your measurement is different from that of your friends. Similarly different measuring units are used in different countries.

For the sake of uniformity, scientists all over the world have adopted a common set of units to express measurements. This system is called as the International System of Units or SI Units.

- SI unit for length is metre
- SI unit for mass is kilogram
- SI unit for time is second
- SI unit for area is m^2
- SI unit for volume is m^3

Prefix

Multiples and sub-multiples of SI units are given as prefixes. Some prefixes are given in the table.